



11.26.25
 - comes together quickly
 - make 1st time
 get out of way
 used (2) bags of green beans
 from whole foods. 24oz each
 - M

green bean casserole with crispy onions

NOVEMBER 18, 2013

Green Bean Casserole with Crispy Onions

Adapted a little from Alton Brown and a little from trial-and-error

Serves 6, or more if you: a) have a lot of sides on the table, which I bet you will, or b) use the higher amount (1.5 pounds) of green beans

Crispy Onions

- 2 medium yellow onions, halved and thinly sliced
- 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
- 2 tablespoons panko or plain breadcrumbs
- 1/2 teaspoon table salt
- Freshly ground black pepper
- Canola, safflower, peanut or other high-heat oil, for deep-frying

Mushroom Sauce

- 3 tablespoons butter
- 12 ounces mushrooms, thinly sliced or coarsely chopped
- Few gratings fresh nutmeg (optional)
- Freshly ground black pepper
- 3/4 teaspoon table salt
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 tablespoons all-purpose flour
- 1 1/2 cups vegetable or chicken broth
- 1/2 cup heavy cream

Assembly

- 1 to 1 1/2 pounds green beans, trimmed and ~~halved~~ ^{thirds} (see note about volume)

11.22.17
 2 1/2 lbs green beans
 18 oz mushrooms
 2 cups veg broth
 3 garlic cloves
 4 flour
 3/4 heavy cream
 - combine sauce & beans
 put in tupperware over-
 night (stores easier in frig)

Make the crispy onions: Toss onion with flour, breadcrumbs, salt and pepper. Heat a 1/2-inch or so of oil in a 12-inch cast iron skillet until a drop of water flicked into it will hiss and sputter. Add onions, just a handful at a time in something close to a single layer, and fry until a light golden brown (they'll get more color in the oven; I overcooked mine a bit, forgetting this). Remove with a spider or large slotted spoon, let oil drip off a little, back into the skillet, then spread onions out on paper towels to drain. Repeat with remaining onions. Set aside until needed; this makes a lot.

Heat oven to 400 degrees F.

Prepare the beans: Bring a large pot of salted water to boil and boil greens for 5 minutes (for standard green beans) or 2 to 3 minutes (for haricot vert, or skinny ones). Drain beans, then plunge them into ice water to full stop them from cooking. Drain again, and set aside. (If you are adamant about only using one pot, you can boil them in your 12-inch cast iron skillet that you use for the other steps. But a saucepan can be easier.)

Make the mushroom sauce: Over medium-high heat, melt butter in the bottom of a 12-inch cast iron skillet. Add the mushrooms, salt and pepper and saute them until they start releasing their liquid, anywhere from 3 to 5 minutes, depending on how they were chopped. Add the garlic and saute one minute more. Add the flour and stir it until it fully coats the mushrooms. Add the broth, 1/4 cup at a time, stirring the whole time. Simmer mixture for 1 minute, then

made in soup pot w/ handle

add cream and bring back to a simmer, cooking until the sauce thickens a bit, about 5 to 6 minutes, stirring frequently.

Assemble and bake: Add cooked greens beans to sauce and stir until they are coated. Sprinkle crispy onions over the top. Bake for 15 minutes, or until sauce is bubbling and onions are a shade darker. Eat at once.

Do ahead, a few ways: Onions can be made long in advance (up to a day) and keep at room temperature, loosely wrapped (they'd get soggy in an airtight container). Green beans can be cooked and kept in fridge until needed, at least one day. Green beans can also be combined with mushroom sauce and kept refrigerated for up to a day. Add onions and bake shortly before serving. Finally, it's less ideal, but the entire dish can be cooked, loosely wrapped (so the crispy top doesn't get soggy) and then reheated in a low oven before serving. Just keep an eye on the topping so it doesn't get too brown while reheating.

A few notes:

- . I made a half-recipe of this dish (in a 9-inch skillet) as there are only three of us. Yours will be bigger. It was so good, we wished we had more.
- . I recommend a range of quantities for the green beans; if you like your casserole to be heavier on sauce and lighter on vegetables, use the lower amount. If you'd like a more vegetable-heavy dish, light-to-moderately coated with the sauce (as mine is in the photos), use the higher amount.
- . This makes a looooot of crispy onions. We didn't mind. But you could probably stretch half the onion volume more thinly over your whole casserole (saving the other half for snacking/sandwiches), or you could just say, "It's Thanksgiving. Let's do this," and use them all. Either way, you win.
- . [Apologies, this was originally in the recipe and I'd meant to make it a footnote due to the unevenness of the results.] If you'd like to bake the onions instead of frying them, Alton Brown recommends spreading them on 1 to 2 oiled baking sheets (but I'd use parchment paper next time) and baking them at 475 (but I might try a lower temperature) for approximately 30 minutes (though I'd check it at 20 minutes), tossing them around a few times to ensure even cooking. However, I found this a little pesky — it's much harder to get them crisp and golden and they're prone to getting too dark before most of them are cooked. I ended up deep-frying the rest and have zero regrets. It's Thanksgiving. Let's do this properly.
- . About the sauce thickness: Alton's original sauce was on the thin side (2T butter for 2T flour). I thickened it when I made it so that it is a moderately thick sauce — it coats the beans (as you can see in the photos) but it does drape a little bit once baked (i.e. there will be more on the lower half of the pan than the top half when it comes out of the oven). If you're nervous and want to make sure that your sauce is definitely very thick, you can do so by using 1 extra tablespoon butter and 1 extra tablespoon flour in the sauce — i.e. more roux makes thicker sauces. Draining your green beans well and even patting them out on towels will help ensure they don't "liquefy" the sauce too much.